

RED DEER COMMUNITY RESOURCES

A verified guide to local supports in the Red Deer area, for people navigating AISH, ADAP, and low income.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown | July 2026

This sheet was put together after a community member sent in a stack of Red Deer resources to share. Every one below has been checked against its official source. Programs and details can change, so confirm the current specifics with each provider when you apply.

A note that helps with several of these:

Being on AISH is a direct qualifier for the transit and recreation fee programs below. If you are on ADAP or in another situation, most of these also have a low-income route, using your CRA Notice of Assessment, so ask about that when you apply. When in doubt, apply and let them assess you.

Getting around: transit

Red Deer Transit Fare Assistance Pass

- Reduces any monthly bus pass to \$34, up to 55 percent off. This is now a permanent program, not a pilot.
- You qualify if you receive AISH, the Guaranteed Income Supplement, or Alberta Income Supports; or you are a Red Deer Housing Authority tenant; or you qualify under the Low Income Cut-Off; or you are approved for the City Recreation Fee Assistance Program below.
- Renew once a year. You can apply at any time.
- Apply in person at Sorenson Station, or online. Details at reddeer.ca, under Transit, Fares and Passes.

Recreation and program fees

City of Red Deer Fee Assistance Program

- Up to \$200 per year per person toward City program registrations, plus a Recreation Pass Card for drop-in activities at City recreation facilities.
- If you are on AISH, you qualify directly. Bring your current AISH direct deposit statement showing the expiry date and the names covered.
- Same-day enrollment in person at the Collicutt Centre, G.H. Dawe Community Centre, Don Moore Recreation Centre, or Michener Aquatic Centre, with your ID, proof of residence, and qualifying document. Or apply online with your CRA Notice of Assessment if you are low income.
- Contact: 403-309-8411 or feeassistance@reddeer.ca
- Good to know: if you provide one-on-one support to a person with special needs at a City facility, your own admission is free.

Red Deer County Fee Assistance Program (for County residents)

- Up to \$300 per person per year toward eligible registration fees. This one is for Red Deer County residents, which is separate from the City of Red Deer.
- Three ways to qualify: by income (household under 200 percent of the Low Income Cut-Off), by a written referral from a community professional, or by being on government assistance.
- Apply online at rdcounty.ca, under Fee Assistance, or by paper form emailed to recreation@rdcounty.ca. A decision comes within 10 business days.

Food

Red Deer Food Bank | 7429 49 Ave, Red Deer

- Emergency food hamper with five to seven days of staples, supplemented with meat, dairy, and produce as available. One hamper every four weeks per household.
- Intake Office is at Bay #12. First come, first served, no appointment needed. Open Monday to Friday, 9 to 11:45 am and 1 to 3:45 pm.
- Bring: government photo ID, photo ID for every adult in the household, ID for any children (Alberta Health Care card or birth certificate), proof of address, and proof of income (a banking app screen is fine).
- Hamper request line: 403-346-1505.
- Community Pantry at Bay #9 is an open shelf anyone facing food insecurity can visit for extra items, 9 am to 4 pm, closed 12:30 to 1.
- Ask about Benefits Wayfinder while you are there. Staff can help you find government benefits you may be eligible for, or you can use it yourself at benefitswayfinder.org.
- More at reddeerfoodbank.com

If you are not sure where to start

Red Deer Public Library, Community Resources

- This is the single best starting point in Red Deer. The library hosts the Red Deer Community Access Guide, a directory updated every two months that pulls together local supports in one place: food and meals, shelter and housing, legal help, healthcare, employment help, mental health and addiction supports, and more.
- Pick up a free printed copy at the library, or browse and download it online at rdpl.org, under Community Resources. The same page also hosts the Red Deer Food Asset Map.

Community connection

WeAreRedDeer, Community Stories

- The City's community storytelling platform, at wearereddeer.ca, where Red Deer residents read and share stories about their community. It is not a support service, but it is a place to feel connected, and to share your own story if you would like to.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

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